Communicative & Grammatical English

Placement Readiness Program — GLA University, Mathura | 5th Sem CEA B.Tech

From alphabets to advanced grammar — let's build your English foundation from scratch!

Recap: Last Session Highlights

4Ds of Time Management
Do, Defer, Delegate, Delete — prioritise tasks smartly

SWOT Analysis
Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities & Threats

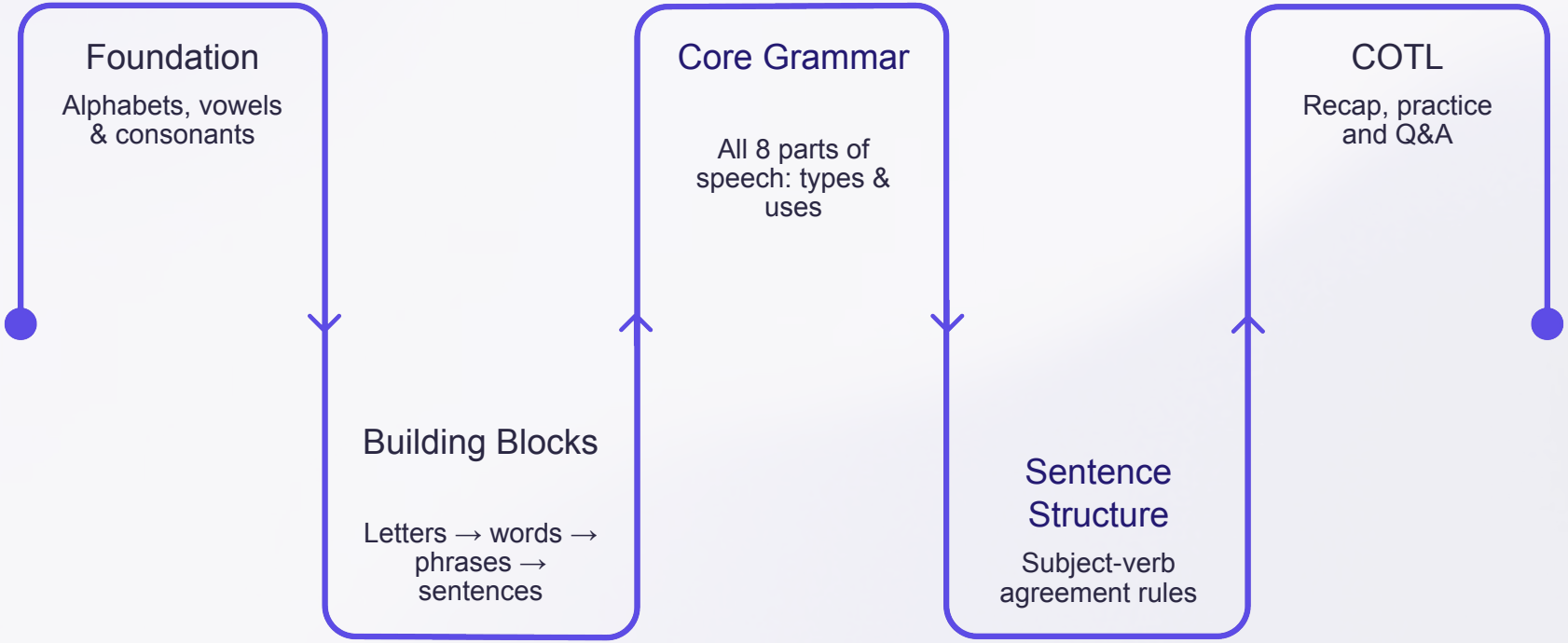
SMART Goal Setting
Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound

Interview Etiquettes
Greet, sit straight, answer confidently — no slang!

Talking Time in English
Daily 15-min English speaking habit to build confidence

Professional Dressing
Formals, neat grooming — no casuals in interviews

Today's Roadmap



We go step-by-step — from the very basics all the way to placement-level grammar. Every concept builds on the last!

CHAPTER 1

Part 1: The Foundation — Alphabets

Before sentences, before words — it all starts with 26 letters. Let's make sure the base is rock solid.

The English Alphabet

English has **26 letters** — A to Z. These 26 letters are the building blocks of the entire English language.

Uppercase: A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
Lowercase: a b c d e f g h i j k l m n o p q r s t u v w x y z

Every single English word — from "a" to "Supercalifragilistic" — is made from just these 26 letters!

Vowels & Consonants

Vowels (5)

A, E, I, O, U

Every word must have at least one vowel. Vowels give sound.

Consonants (21)

All remaining 21 letters — B, C, D, F, G, H, J, K, L, M, N, P, Q, R, S, T, V, W, X, Y, Z

Consonants give shape to words.

Memory Trick

> "A rat in the house may eat the ice cream"

Take the first letter of each word: **A** rat **I**n the **H**ouse **M**ay **E**at the **I**ce **C**ream → **A, E, I, O, U** ✓

Say it a few times — you'll never forget your vowels again!

From Letters → Words

1

Letter

A single alphabet symbol: *a, b, c…*

2

Word

A meaningful collection of letters: *cat, run, happy*

3

Meaningful!

Words must have at least one vowel to be pronounceable

Example: C + A + T = *cat* (an animal) | R + U + N = *run* (an action) | H + A + P + P + Y = *happy* (a feeling)

From Words → Phrases & Sentences

🔷 A Phrase

A group of words that does **NOT** make complete sense on its own.

> "the big dog" — who? what happened? **Incomplete!**

No subject performing a complete action. Leaves you hanging.

✔ A Sentence

A group of words that makes **COMPLETE sense.**

> "The big dog barked loudly." — complete thought ✓

A sentence always has a **Subject** (who/what) + **Verb** (action/state). That's the golden rule!

Types of Sentences

1

Declarative

Makes a statement.

"Rahul works at TCS."

2

Interrogative

Asks a question.

"Does Rahul work at TCS?"

3

Imperative

Gives a command.

"Submit the report now."

4

Exclamatory

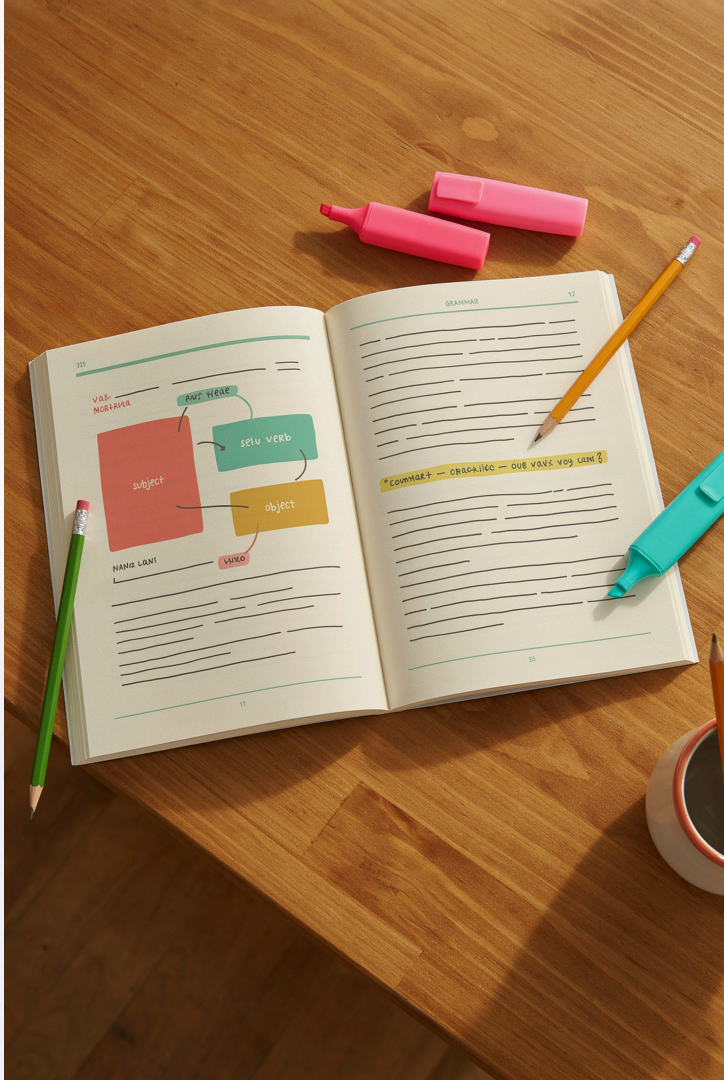
Shows strong emotion.

"What a great result!"

CHAPTER 2

Part 2: Parts of Speech

Every word has a job to do in a sentence. Let's meet all 8 team members!



What Are Parts of Speech?

Every word plays a ROLE

Just like every player on a cricket team has a different role — batsman, bowler, wicketkeeper — every word in English has a specific job. That job is called its **Part of Speech.**

The 8 Parts of Speech:

1. Noun
2. Pronoun
3. Verb
4. Adjective
5. Adverb
6. Preposition
7. Conjunction
8. Interjection

Why it matters: Knowing parts of speech helps you build correct, clear sentences — essential for placement tests and interviews!

1. Noun — The Name Giver

Person

Rahul, Priya, Engineer, Teacher

Place

Mathura, GLA University, Delhi, Lab

Thing

laptop, book, project, report

Idea

honesty, courage, freedom, intelligence

> *"Rahul bought a laptop from the market."* — Rahul, laptop, market are all Nouns ✓

Types of Nouns

Proper Noun

Specific, unique name — always capitalised: *GLA University, Mathura, Sunita, TCS*

Common Noun

General category name: *college, city, girl, company*

Abstract Noun

Cannot be touched/seen — ideas & feelings: *courage, honesty, freedom, intelligence*

Collective Noun

Name for a group: *a team of engineers, a class of students, a panel of judges*

Countable vs Uncountable

Countable: books, offers, questions | **Uncountable:** water, advice, information, furniture

2. Pronoun — The Substitute

A **Pronoun** replaces a noun to avoid repetition and make sentences smoother.

Without pronoun: 😵

> *"Rahul said Rahul will submit Rahul's project."*

With pronoun: ✓

> *"Rahul said he will submit his project."*

Common pronouns: I, we, you, he, she, it, they, me, him, her, us, them

Types of Pronouns

Personal

I, you, he, she, we, they

Possessive

my, your, his, her, our, their

Reflexive

myself, yourself, himself, themselves

Demonstrative

this, that, these, those

Interrogative

who, what, which, whom

Relative

who, which, that — *"The student who topped is from GLA."*

3. Verb — The Action Word

A **Verb** shows an action, occurrence, or state of being. **NO sentence is complete without a verb!**

Action Verbs

run, write, code, speak, submit, present, apply

> *"She codes every day."*

State / Linking Verbs

is, am, are, was, were, seem, become

> *"He is an engineer."*

Types of Verbs

1 **Transitive**

Needs an object — *"She wrote a program."* (program = object)

2 **Intransitive**

No object needed — *"He runs fast."* | *"She smiled."*

3 **Auxiliary / Helping**

Support the main verb — *is, am, are, was, were, has, have, had, do, did, will*

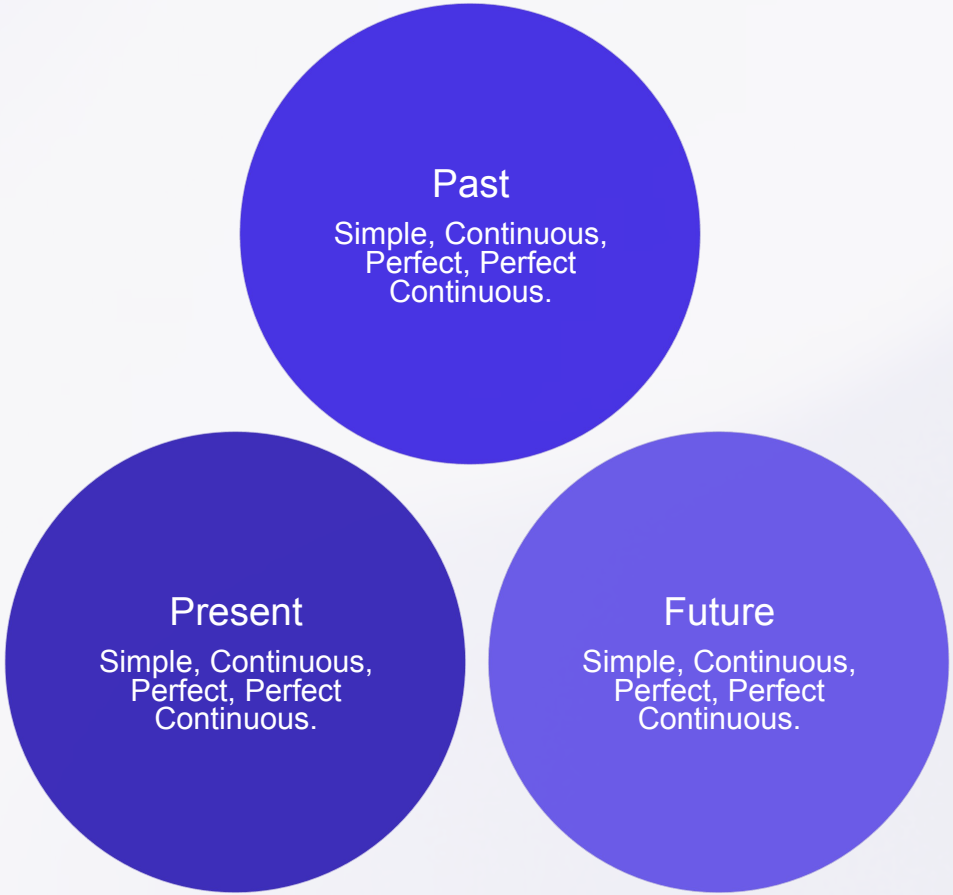
4 **Modal Verbs**

Express possibility, permission, obligation — *can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must*

5 **Phrasal Verbs**

Verb + preposition = new meaning — *give up, look into, carry on, put off*

Verb Tenses — Quick Overview



4. Adjective — The Describer

An **Adjective** describes or modifies a noun or pronoun. It answers:

- **Which one?** — *"This resume"*
- **What kind?** — *"a brilliant engineer"*
- **How many?** — *"three offers"*
- **How much?** — *"some experience"*

Two Positions:

Before noun: *"a smart student"*

After linking verb: *"She is smart"*

Types of Adjectives

Descriptive

Describes quality: *tall, intelligent, hardworking, lazy*

Quantitative

Shows amount: *some, many, few, all, no, enough*

Numeral

Shows number/order: *one, first, second, triple, both*

Demonstrative

Points to noun: *this, that, these, those*

Possessive

Shows ownership: *my, your, his, her, our, their*

Degrees of Comparison

smart → smarter → **smartest**

good → better → **best**

bad → worse → **worst**

5. Adverb — The Modifier

An **Adverb** modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb. It answers: *How? When? Where? How much? How often?*

Modifying a Verb

"She speaks fluently."

How does she speak?

Fluently.

Modifying an Adjective

"He is very confident."

How confident? Very.

Modifying an Adverb

"She works quite efficiently."

How efficiently? Quite.

Types of Adverbs

Manner

quickly, slowly, fluently, carefully

Time

now, yesterday, soon, already, still

Frequency

always, often, sometimes, never, rarely

Degree

very, quite, almost, too, enough

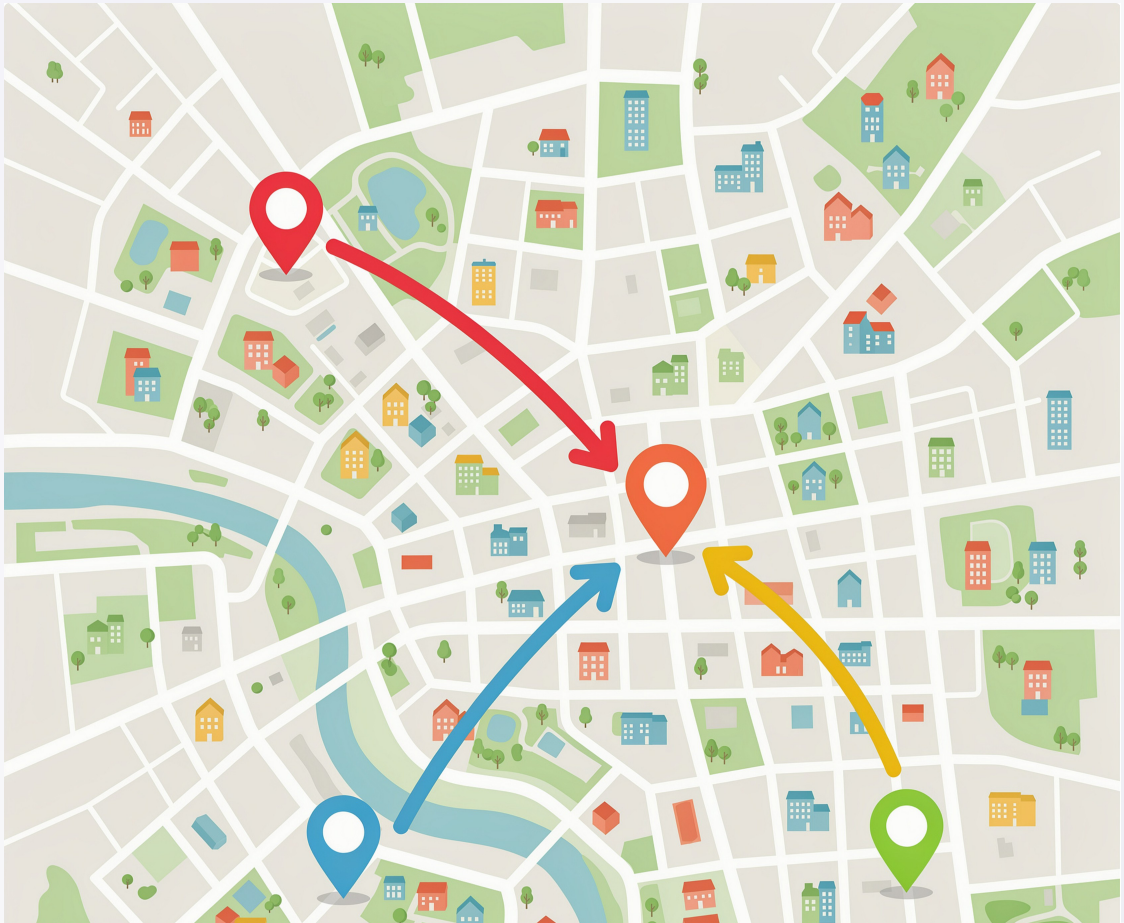
Place

here, there, everywhere, outside

🧠 Quick Tip

Many adverbs end in **-ly**: quick**ly**, clear**ly**, honest**ly**, fluent**ly**

6. Preposition — The Connector



What does a Preposition do?

A **Preposition** links a noun/pronoun to other words, showing the relationship of **time, place, direction, or manner.**

Common Prepositions:

in, on, at, by, for, with, about, between, under, over, through, across, towards

> *"The interview is at 10 AM in the conference room on the third floor."*

Notice how each preposition tells us something different — time, place, location!

Spiderman Learns Prepositions! (Activity)

Through the City

Spiderman is swinging **through** the city — *movement through a space*

On the Building

He lands **on** the building — *surface contact*

Behind the Water Tank

He hides **behind** the water tank — *concealed position*

Under the Bridge

The villain is **under** the bridge — *below a surface*

Across the River → Towards MJ

Spiderman swings **across** the river **towards** her — *direction of movement*

☞ **Activity:** Draw Spiderman's route and label each preposition!

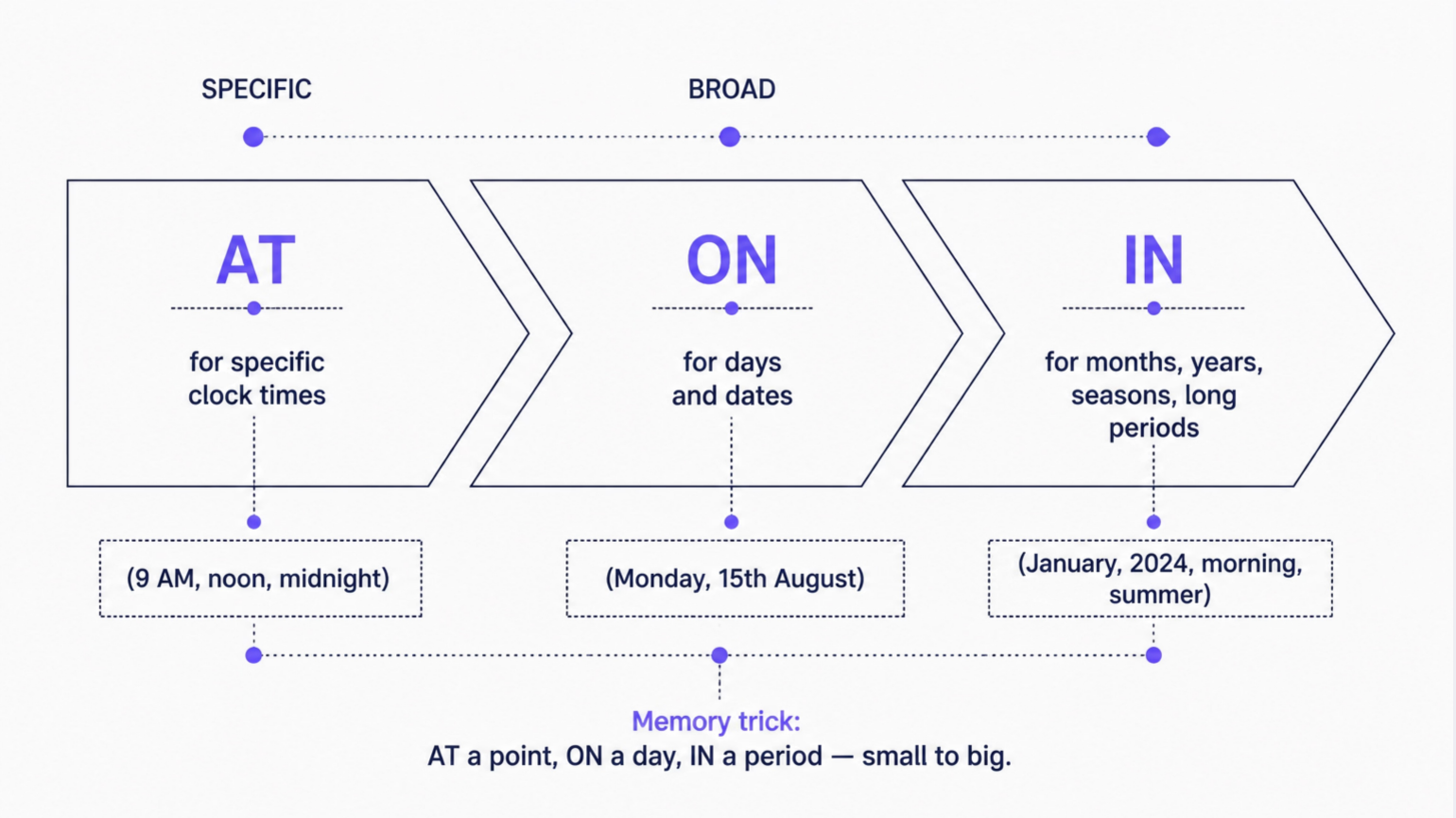
Preposition of Place

IN	ON	AT
Enclosed space	Surface contact	Specific point
"The laptop is in the bag."	*"The book is on the table."*	*"Meet me at the gate."*

UNDER	BETWEEN
Below something	Two things
"The cable is under the desk."	*"Sit between Rahul and Priya."*

Also useful: BEHIND / IN FRONT OF / NEXT TO — relative positions in everyday conversation and interviews

Preposition of Time



Memory Trick: AT a point → ON a day → IN a period. Think: **small to big!**

Commonly Confused Prepositions

In vs Into

"She is in the room" (static — already there) vs *"She walked into the room"* (movement — entering)

Between vs Among

Between = exactly 2 things: *"between Rahul and Priya"*

Among = 3 or more things: *"among the team members"*

Since vs For

Since = point in time: *"Since 2020"* (when it started)

For = duration: *"For 4 years"* (how long)

On vs Upon

"The cat sat on the mat" (everyday use) vs *"Once upon a time"* (formal/idiomatic expression)

Preposition of Relationship & Direction

WITH — Accompaniment

"She came with her team."

BY — Agent / Means

"The project was done by Rahul." / *"Travel by bus."*

OF — Belonging

"The result of the test was good."

TO / TOWARDS — Direction

"Go to the lab." / *"Walk towards the exit."*

ACROSS / THROUGH / ALONG

Movement paths — *"Walk along the corridor."*

7. Conjunction — The Joiner

A **Conjunction** joins words, phrases, or clauses together, creating smooth, flowing sentences.

> *"I applied for TCS and Infosys but got only one offer."*

Without conjunctions, sentences become choppy and disconnected. Conjunctions are the glue of English grammar!

Think of conjunctions like a **bridge** — they connect two ideas so they make sense together.

Types of Conjunctions

Coordinating — FANBOYS

For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So

"She studied hard, so she cleared the test."

Subordinating

because, although, since, if, when, unless, until

"Although he was nervous, he answered well."

Correlative (Pairs)

either…or, neither…nor, both…and, not only…but also

"Not only did she code, but also she presented well."

8. Interjection — The Emotion Word

An **Interjection** expresses sudden emotion or feeling. It stands alone and is followed by **!** or **,**

> **In interviews:** Use mild interjections — *"Oh, that's an interesting question!"* — avoid loud or dramatic ones

Quick Recap: All 8 Parts of Speech

Noun

Names a person/place/thing/idea: *Rahul, Mathura, laptop*

Pronoun

Replaces a noun: *he, she, they, it*

Verb

Shows action/state: *run, is, write*

Adjective

Describes a noun: *smart, three, this*

Adverb

Modifies verb/adj/adverb: *quickly, very, always*

Preposition

Shows relationship: *in, on, at, by*

Conjunction

Joins clauses: *and, but, because*

Interjection

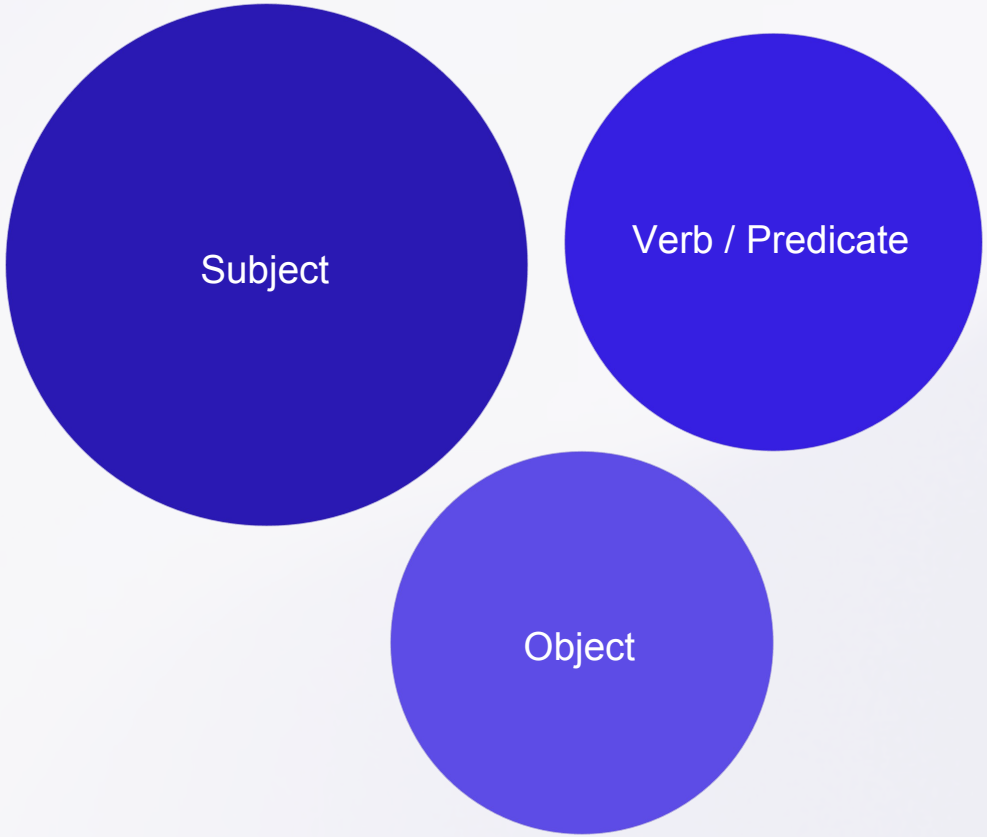
Expresses emotion: *Wow! Alas!*

CHAPTER 3

Part 3: Sentence Structure & Subject-Verb Agreement

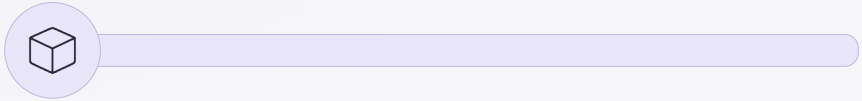
Now that we know all the parts — let's learn how to put them together correctly!

Anatomy of a Sentence



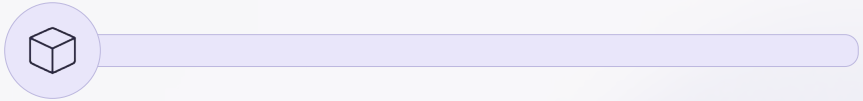
Most English sentences follow the **SVO formula** — Subject + Verb + Object. Master this and you can build any sentence correctly!

Types of Sentences by Structure



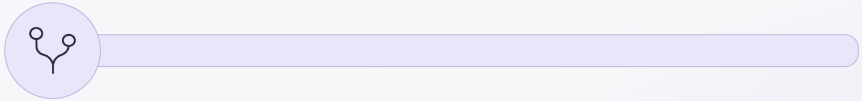
Simple

One subject + one verb: *"Rahul codes."*



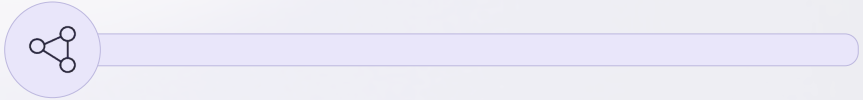
Compound

Two independent clauses + conjunction: *"Rahul codes, and Priya tests."*



Complex

Main clause + subordinate clause: *"Although Rahul was tired, he finished the project."*



Compound-Complex

Mix of both: *"Rahul coded all night, and Priya tested it because the deadline was near."*

Subject-Verb Agreement — The Golden Rule

The verb must **agree in number** with the subject. This is one of the most tested grammar rules in placement exams!

✗ *"She write well."* — WRONG!
✓ *"She writes well."* — CORRECT!

Subject-Verb Agreement — Tricky Rules

Collective Nouns = Singular Verb

"The team is ready." ✓ (NOT "are")

The team, class, committee, panel — all treated as ONE unit

Either / Neither = Singular

"Neither of the answers is correct." ✓

Either/Neither always takes a singular verb

Joined by AND = Plural

"Ram and Shyam are friends." ✓

AND creates a compound subject = plural

OR / NOR = Nearest Subject Rule

"Either the manager or the employees are responsible." ✓

Verb agrees with whichever subject is closer to it

More Subject-Verb Agreement Rules

Indefinite Pronouns (Singular)

everyone, someone, nobody, each, every — always singular

"Everyone is present." ✓

Amounts & Distances = Singular

"Five kilometres is a long walk." ✓

The amount is treated as one measurement

Titles & Subjects as One Unit

"Data Structures is my favourite subject." ✓

The subject title is treated as a single unit

Intervening Phrases Don't Change the Verb

"The box of chocolates is on the table." ✓ (NOT "are")

The real subject is "box" — singular!

Common Grammar Mistakes to Avoid

✕ Wrong (Indian English)	✓ Correct	Why?
"I am having a doubt"	*"I have a doubt"*	Stative verb — no continuous form
"She is knowing the answer"	*"She knows the answer"*	Know = stative verb
"We discussed about the project"	*"We discussed the project"*	Discuss never takes 'about'
"He gave me an advice"	*"He gave me advice"*	Advice = uncountable noun
"I am agree"	*"I agree"*	Agree is not used with 'am'

Articles — A, An, The (Bonus Essential)

A

Before consonant sounds: *"a university," "a book," "a report"*

AN

Before vowel sounds: *"an engineer," "an honest person," "an hour"*

THE

Specific/known noun: *"The interview went well."*

No Article

General plural/uncountable: *"Engineers are in demand." / "Water is essential."*

Tricky Cases

> "**an hour**" — the 'h' is silent, so it sounds like a vowel → use AN

> "**a university**" — sounds like 'yoo-niversity' → starts with a consonant sound → use A

It's all about the **SOUND**, not the spelling! If it sounds like a vowel, use AN.

Tense Consistency in Sentences

✕ Don't Switch Tenses Mid-Sentence!

> ~~"She walked in and says hello."~~

✓ Keep It Consistent

> "She walked in and **said** hello."

In Interviews — Use Tenses Right:

Simple Present

For facts: *"I work in Java."*

Simple Past

For experiences: *"I completed my internship at Wipro."*

Future

For plans: *"I will join in July."*

Putting It All Together — Sample Sentences

Let's label every word in a sentence to see all 8 Parts of Speech working together:

> *"Rahul (Noun/Subject) quickly (Adverb) submitted (Verb) his (Pronoun) brilliant (Adjective) project (Noun/Object) on (Preposition) time."*

> *"Wow! (Interjection) She (Pronoun) is (Verb) very (Adverb) confident (Adjective), and (Conjunction) she (Pronoun) speaks (Verb) fluently (Adverb)."*

Every word has a job. Now you can identify ALL of them! 🎯

🕷️ Spiderman Activity — Fill the Prepositions!

Sentence 1

"Spiderman jumped ___ the rooftop and landed ___ the street."

✔ **off / on**

Sentence 2

"He hid ___ the two buildings and waited ___ midnight."

✔ **between / until**

Sentence 3

"The web was stuck ___ the ceiling ___ the museum."

✔ **to / of**

Sentence 4 & 5

"He has been a superhero ___ 2002." → ✔ **since**

"He fought the villain ___ 3 hours." → ✔ **for**

✔ Check your answers with a partner — first one done shouts **"Thwip!"** 🕸️

Practice Exercise — Identify the Parts of Speech

Sentence: *"Wow! The smart students from GLA quickly solved the difficult problem in the lab."*

Word	Part of Speech	Word	Part of Speech
Wow!	Interjection	quickly	Adverb
smart	Adjective	solved	Verb
students	Noun	difficult	Adjective
from	Preposition	problem	Noun
GLA	Proper Noun	in / lab	Preposition / Noun

Try it first! Write your answers — then check the table. We'll discuss together! 💬

🎯 Activity: Noun Hunt in 60 Seconds!

> *"The team of engineers from GLA University presented their project on artificial intelligence with great confidence at the seminar in Mathura."*

Proper Nouns

GLA University, Mathura

Common Nouns

team, engineers, project, seminar

Abstract Nouns

confidence, intelligence

Collective Noun

team

⏱️ 60 seconds on the clock — GO! First team to get all 8 wins! 🏆

Practice Exercise — Correct the Sentences

#	✕ Incorrect Sentence	✓ Correction	Rule
1.	*"She don't know the answer."*	*"She **doesn't** know the answer."*	She = singular → doesn't
2.	*"The team are working hard."*	*"The team **is** working hard."*	Collective noun = singular
3.	*"He is more smarter than me."*	*"He is **smarter** than me."*	No double comparative
4.	*"I have went to Delhi yesterday."*	*"I **went** to Delhi yesterday."*	Past simple, not perfect
5.	*"Neither of the students are present."*	*"Neither of the students **is** present."*	Neither = singular

Error Spotting — Exam Style (Set 1)

Find the error in the underlined part. These are the exact types of questions you'll see in TCS/Infosys/Wipro tests!

Q1.

"She <u>don't</u> know the answer to the question."

Error: **don't** → ✓ **doesn't** — singular subject 'she' needs singular verb

Q2.

"The <u>informations</u> given in the report is incorrect."

Error: **informations** → ✓ **information** — uncountable noun, no plural!

Q3.

"He is <u>more smarter</u> than his brother."

Error: **more smarter** → ✓ **smarter** — double comparative is WRONG!

Q4.

"Neither of the students <u>are</u> ready."

Error: **are** → ✓ **is** — neither = singular, always takes singular verb

Error Spotting — Exam Style (Set 2)

Spot the error and correct it — common in **TCS, Infosys, Wipro** placement tests:

Q1.

"I have went to the interview yesterday."

✔ **I went** to the interview yesterday. — Past simple, not present perfect!

Q2.

"The team are performing very well this season."

✔ **The team is** performing… — Collective noun = singular verb

Q3.

"She is knowing the answer."

✔ **She knows** the answer. — Stative verb 'know' — no continuous form allowed!

Q4.

"He gave me an useful advice."

✔ Two errors! → **a useful** ('yoo' sound = consonant → 'a') AND **advice** is uncountable (no 'a' at all!)

Error Spotting — Exam Style (Set 3)

Sentence correction — pick the correct version (MCQ style — exactly like TCS/Wipro!):

Question	Options	✔ Answer
"Each of the boys have submitted their form."	a) have submitted their b) has submitted his c) have submitted his	**b) has submitted his** (each = singular)
"We discussed about the new project plan."	a) discussed about b) discussed c) have discussed about	**b) discussed** (no 'about' after discuss)
"Five hundred rupees are a big amount."	a) are a big b) is a big c) are the big	**b) is a big** (amount as a unit = singular)
"I am agree with your point."	a) am agree b) agree c) am agreed	**b) agree** ('agree' not used with 'am')

Fill in the Blanks — Prepositions

Fill each blank with the correct preposition:

1. The exam is ___ Monday ___ 10 AM. → **on / at**
2. She has been studying ___ three hours. → **for**
3. He has been in Mathura ___ 2021. → **since**
4. The results are ___ the notice board. → **on**
5. Divide the work ___ the four team members. → **among**

Remember: FOR = duration | SINCE = point in time | AMONG = 3 or more | BETWEEN = exactly 2

🎮 Fun Activity: Parts of Speech Bingo!

How to Play:

1. Each student draws a **3×3 grid**
2. Fill it with any **9 words** from today's lesson
3. Teacher reads a definition or example sentence
4. Cross off the matching word
5. First full row = shout **"BINGO!"** 🎉

✅ 🏆 Winner gets to ask the teacher ONE tricky question — or skip a doubt!

Example Calls:

> *"I modify a verb and end in -ly"* → **quickly**

> *"I join two clauses"* → **but / and**

> *"I show a surface relationship"* → **on**

> *"I replace a noun"* → **he / she / they**

English for Placement Tests — Key Tips

Reading Comprehension

Read the passage first, then questions — underline keywords before answering

Error Spotting

Check Subject-Verb Agreement, Tense consistency, Articles, Prepositions — in that order!

Sentence Correction

Eliminate options that change meaning or have grammar errors — use process of elimination

Vocabulary

Learn 5 new words daily — always with usage in a full sentence, not just definition

Spoken English Tip: Think in English, not Hindi first. Practice translating your thoughts directly!

Daily English Habits for Placement Readiness

📖 Read Daily

One English article daily — Times of India, BBC, Hindu. Builds vocabulary + comprehension.

🗣️ Speak 15 Minutes

Daily English speaking habit — even with yourself in the mirror. Builds fluency and confidence.

✍️ Write 5 Sentences

Daily writing using today's grammar rules. Writing cements what you've learned.

📱 Change Phone Language

Switch your phone to English. You use it 6+ hours a day — make every minute count!

🎧 Watch with Subtitles

One English video daily — TED Talks, YouTube. Trains your ear for natural English.

COTL

Closing of the Loop

Let's close today's loop — recap what we covered, lock in the key takeaways, and clear all doubts before we leave!

Session Recap — What We Covered Today

✔ The Foundation

26 Alphabets → 5 Vowels + 21 Consonants → Letters → Words → Phrases → Sentences (4 types)

✔ All 8 Parts of Speech

Noun, Pronoun, Verb, Adjective, Adverb, Preposition, Conjunction, Interjection — with all types, uses & Indian English examples

✔ Prepositions

Place (in/on/at/under), Time (in/on/at), Relationship (by/with/of) + Spiderman activity!

✔ Sentence Structure & SVA

Simple/Compound/Complex sentences + 6 Subject-Verb Agreement rules + error spotting

Key Takeaways — Remember These Always

Every Sentence

Needs a **Subject + Verb** — no exceptions!

Preposition Trick

IN = period | ON = day | AT = specific time/point

Subject-Verb Agreement

Singular subject → singular verb. Plural subject → plural verb. Always!

Adj vs Adv

Adjectives describe **nouns**. Adverbs describe **verbs, adjectives & adverbs**.

3 More to Know

Conjunctions **join**. Prepositions **relate**. Interjections **express emotion**.

Doubt Clearing — Ask Now!

This is your time — **no question is too basic. Ask freely!**

- Any confusion on Parts of Speech?
- Struggling with a specific preposition rule?
- Subject-Verb Agreement still tricky?
- Want more examples on any topic?
- Questions on the error spotting pattern?

> The only silly question is the one you didn't ask. Your batchmates probably have the same doubt — be the one to ask it! 💬

Start Speaking English — Today, Not Tomorrow

You Don't Need to Be Perfect

You need to be **understood**. Communication is the goal — not perfection.

Every Expert Was Once a Beginner

Sachin Tendulkar played his first match too. He wasn't born hitting centuries!

180 Days = Fluency

Your placement is 6 months away. **180 days** of daily practice = real, confident fluency.

Start Today. Right Now.

Action: Introduce yourself in English to the person next to you. Right now. Go!